WEEK 34 · 17–22 AUGUST 2026

2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

Week 34 Delivery Report

What moved this week, initiative by initiative, with the delivery schedule it sits in.

Cyber & Infra · Data · Core · Sector Intelligence · D&E · University Services

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

Core 7 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 7 initiatives moved, led by HIQ – QAS Auth Migration, MyQS Cerebrum, QAS Auth. Production cutover done, later than planned. Shared-client origins and the M2M audience move landed in the Auth0 tenant, and HolonIQ claims are stamped on access tokens.

Risks & decisions. HIQ – QAS Auth Migration: HolonIQ needs connecting to QAS Pulse. Now that HolonIQ is in production, its events still need to reach the Pulse pipeline.

Sector Intelligence 3 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 3 initiatives moved, led by QAS Stars, 1 Mentor IBM, Partnerships New. Launched Rankings Admin in Back Office, completed the QS Stars visual refresh and shipped auth session synchronisation fixes. SSO for IBM has been completed and the IBM white-label configuration has been set up.

Risks & decisions. Partnerships New: Partner Discovery admin module. It lives in the Back Office, which has moved to legacy, and is still required for some QPD features. Decision needed: migrate it into the Partner Discovery app or create a standalone app.

D&E 2 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 2 initiatives moved, led by TU – Career Match Microsite, TU Performance & Upgrade. The team can now see how candidates move through Career Match and where they drop off. All issues fixed, but the release is on hold until the new servers are set up and tested.

Risks & decisions. TU Performance & Upgrade: Angular upgrade. The decision has been made to wait for the new servers to be set up before releasing this new version. Angular upgrade. Drupal upgrade.

University Services 2 INITIATIVES

Outcomes. 2 initiatives moved, led by Aurora Data Integrity, Aurora Implementation. The process has started to update all missing COI objects across all portals.

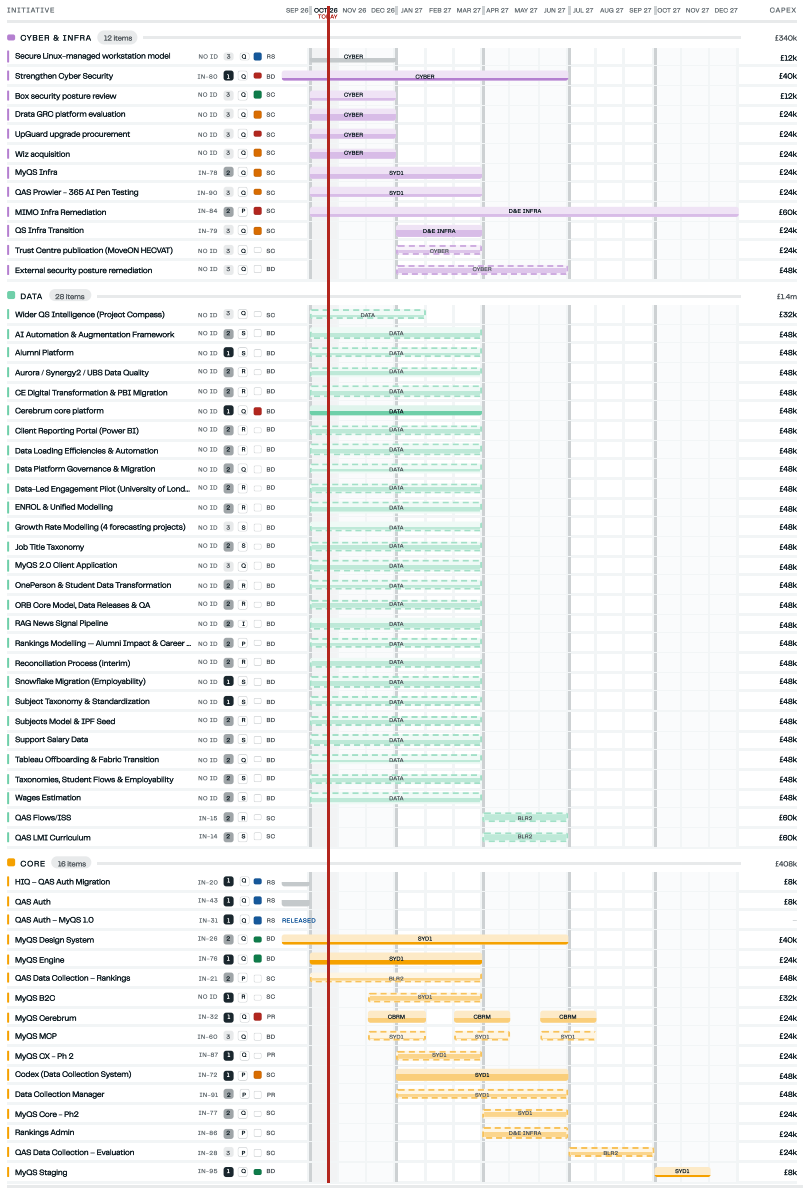
Risks & decisions. Aurora Implementation: Sunway WhatsApp onboarding. The current number is a landline rather than a mobile number, and Aircall and Twilio do not currently offer Malaysian mobile numbers. CIPTEX SIP trunking.

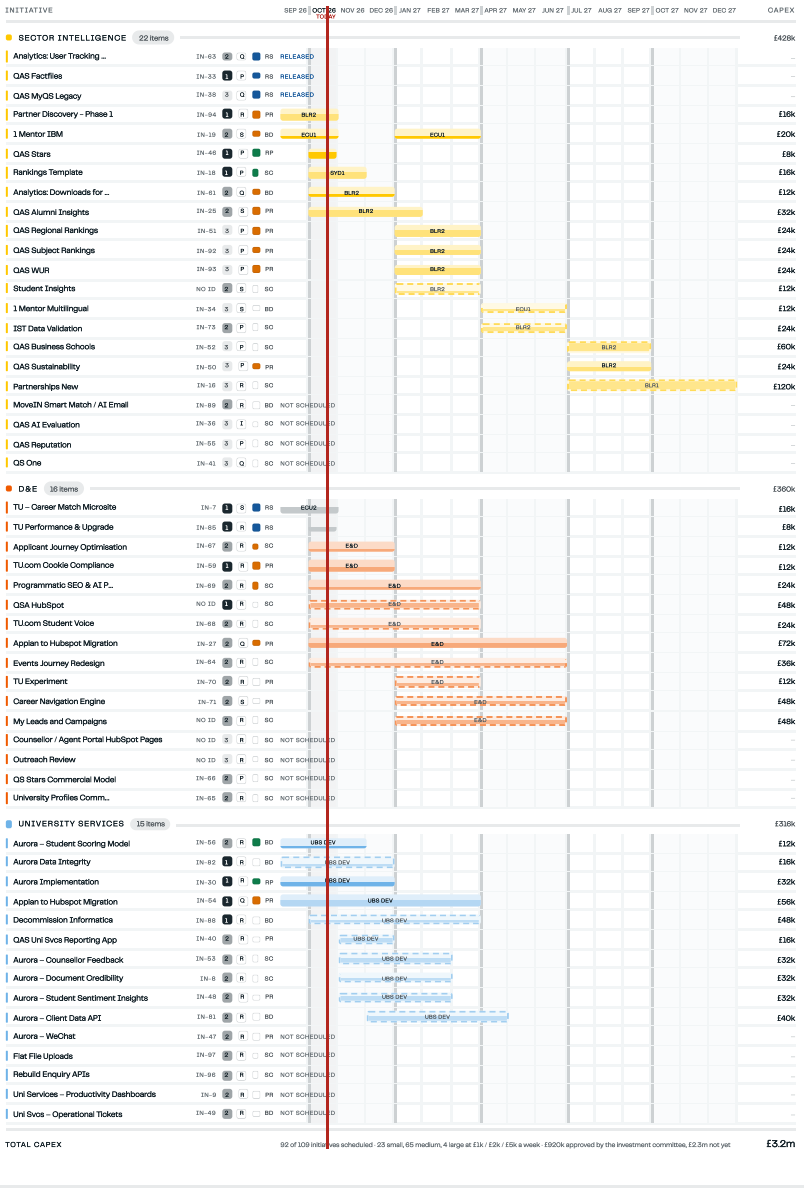
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2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

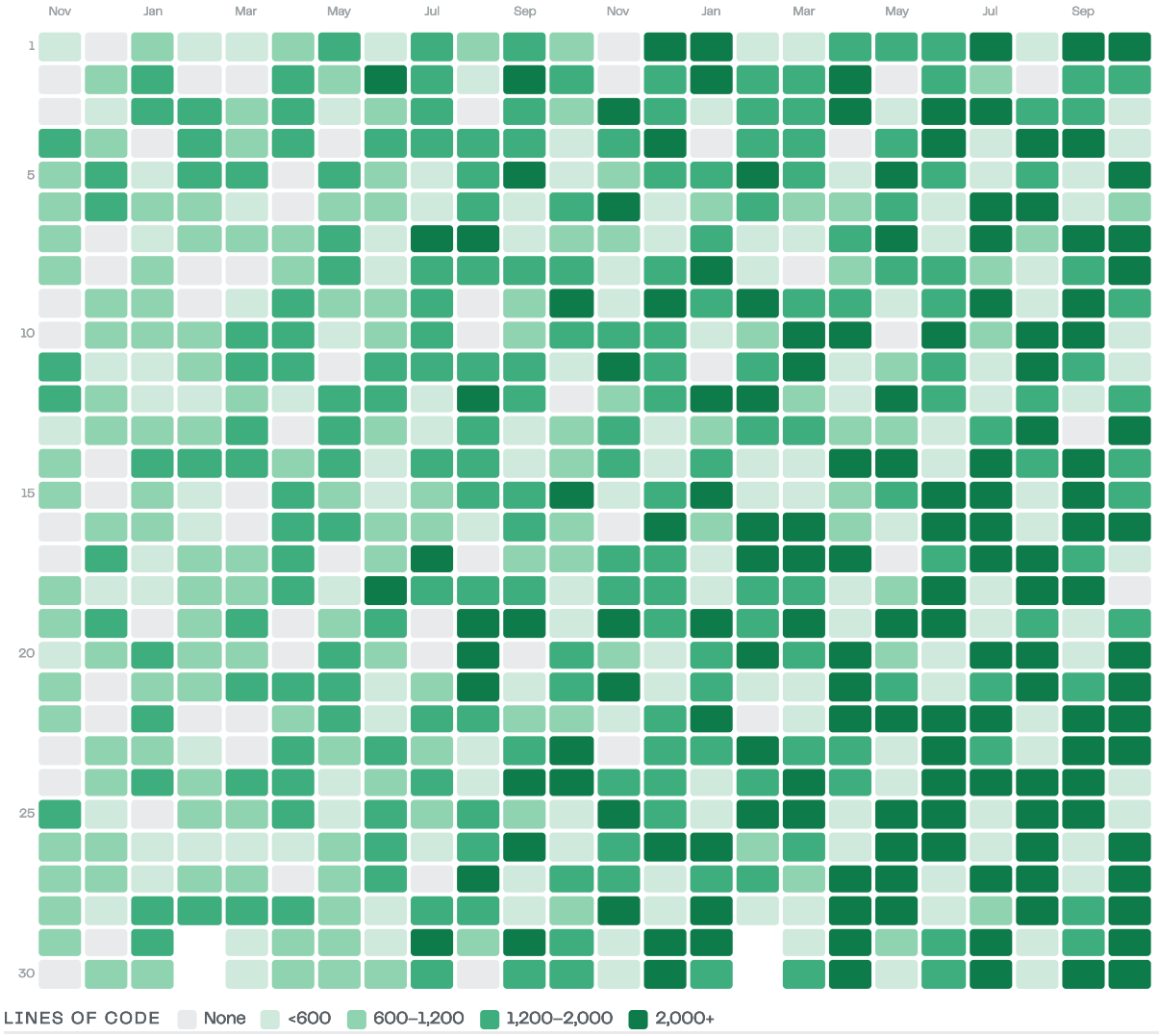
Delivery schedule 109 initiatives





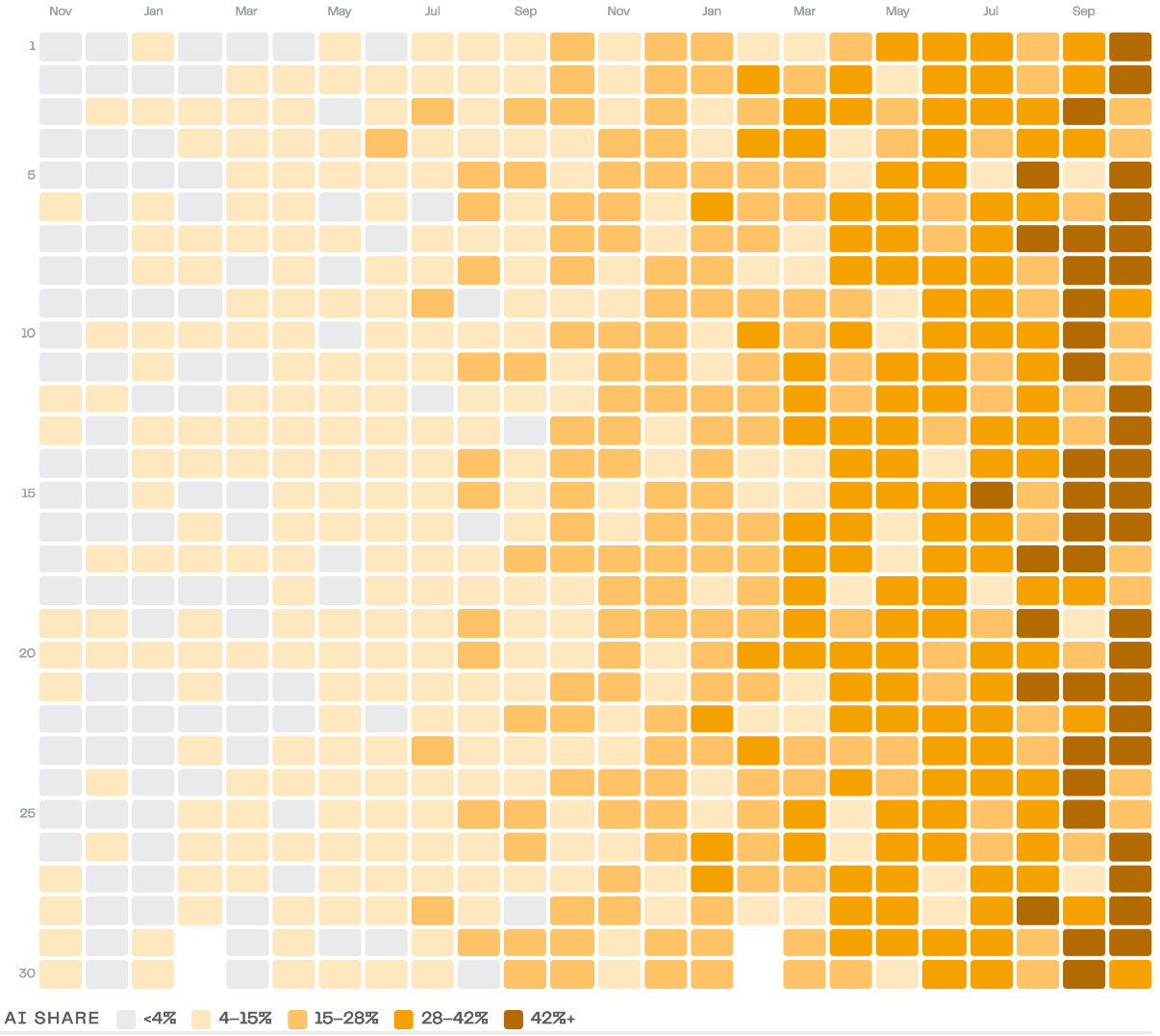
Productivity Heatmap NOV 24 – OCT 26

Lines of code committed a day.



AI Code Intensity NOV 24 – OCT 26

Share of committed code written by AI.



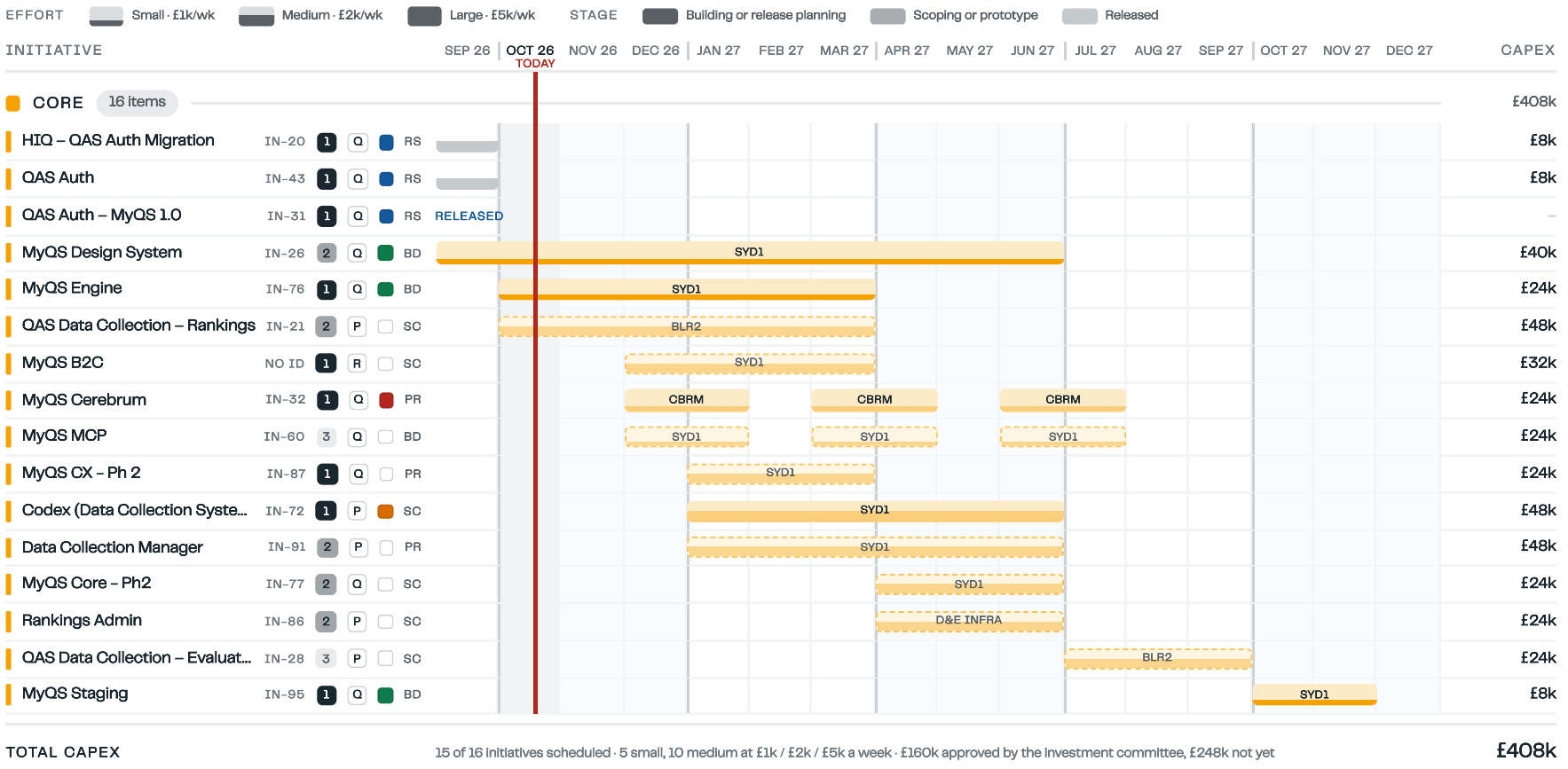
2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

SECTION 1 OF 4

Core

7 initiatives reported

1 scoping
1 prototype
2 building
3 released



HIQ – QAS Auth Migration

IN-20 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · SYD1 · RELEASED

Production cutover done, later than planned. Shared-client origins and the M2M audience move landed in the Auth0 tenant, and HolonIQ claims are stamped on access tokens. On the data side, entitlement_outbox joined the production DMS selection rules with an append-only posture enforced against default ACLs; account and account_organization_authority were added as the sixth and seventh outbox entities; and the entitlement forwarder went live against the HolonIQ production bus, enriching org-link events with the legacy core id through an S3 crosswalk.

Risks and decisions. HolonIQ needs connecting to QAS Pulse. Now that HolonIQ is in production, its events still need to reach the Pulse pipeline.

MyQS Cerebrum

IN-32 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · CEREBRUM · PROTOTYPE

Estate config gated at build and boot with cross-estate defaults removed; the supergraph URL sourced from the qas/auth0 secret; the obsolete CerebrumAccessGuard retired now that product entitlement governs access; and ContentLayout, TableView and ListWidget adopted across the app. Entity ingestion is live end to end. A submitted data package is now validated through ten stages and committed to the core store, with every change versioned and attributed. This was the week's main body of work. Entity search and version history. Staff can search records by QS ID, see an entity's current state and step through its history with a property-level diff of what changed at each version. Live and verified end to end. Every change is traceable.

Risks and decisions. A concurrency safeguard is switched off until someone sets it: the protection against two simultaneous submissions colliding on one record lives in a deployment setting, not in code. Decision: who sets it, and whether before or after the first real backfill. A history-backfill fix is still open, and entity type definitions are behind schedule.

QAS Auth

IN-43 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · SYD1 · RELEASED

an email-first, passkey-first login and signup with consent collected once at the OTP step, replacing the three-policy line with QS General Terms and a marketing opt-in that persists to user_preference. passkey_enrolled now syncs from Auth0 log events and the post-login hook, user-facing Auth0 links are minted on the tenant custom domain, and hook auth became pipeline-owned so the drift warning could be retired.

Risks and decisions. Marketing consent is not yet piped through to HubSpot. The opt-in is captured at signup and persisted to user_preference, but nothing forwards it to HubSpot yet.

QAS Auth – MyQS 1.0

IN-31 · BLR2 · RELEASED

Launched Rankings Admin in Back Office, completed the QS Stars visual refresh and shipped auth session synchronisation fixes.

MyQS Design System

IN-26 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · BUILDING

A shared three-step profile form exported on a ./profile-form subpath and raised from QSThemeProvider; the www.qs.com cookie consent adopted instead of re-asking in each app; a pre-paint theme plugin shipped from ./vite; and portal-first login, so satellites bounce to MyQS rather than self-hosting interactive login. The week closed on 2.1.0: a shell-wide toast provider from Caitlin, and the auth profile republished as a state every consumer must handle. 2.0.14 to 2.1.0.

Rankings Admin

IN-86 · BLR2 · SCOPING

Launched Rankings Admin in Back Office, completed the QS Stars visual refresh and shipped auth session synchronisation fixes.

MyQS MCP

IN-60 · SYD1 · CHARLIE LIU · BUILDING

MCP brought up on the eu-west-2 production estate with estate-aware runtimes and a product-entitlement access model; QAS-Infra now accepts environment=production and routes prod branches through cfg.is_production; and CloudFormation no longer manages the data-gql Snowflake secret value.

SYD1

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

HolonIQ to QAS migration · with Ming Shi: Production cutover done, later than planned. Shared-client origins and the M2M audience move landed in the Auth0 tenant, and HolonIQ claims are stamped on access tokens. On the data side, entitlement_outbox joined the production DMS selection rules with an append-only posture enforced against default ACLs; account and account_organization_authority were added as the sixth and seventh outbox entities; and the entitlement forwarder went live against the HolonIQ production bus, resolving its PutEvents region from the bus ARN, carrying per-detail-type and retry stocktake counters and enriching org-link events with the legacy core id through an S3 crosswalk.

Cerebrum

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Data Pipeline (dbt and Dagster): Entity ingestion is live end to end. A submitted data package is now validated through ten stages and committed to the core store, with every change versioned and attributed. This was the week's main body of work. Front end and Registry API: Entity search and version history. Staff can search records by QS ID, see an entity's current state and step through its history with a property-level diff of what changed at each version. Live and verified end to end. Data Store (Snowflake): Every change is traceable. The history model treats the original data load as a real commit rather than a special case, so 'this value has always been here' is now an auditable answer instead of a gap.

SYD1

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. QS Analytics subdomain cutover is a planned hold. QAS-Design #241 is staged behind the two-stage database rename timeline and lands once the cutover is scheduled. Factfiles login redirect. Needs to be configured to my2.qs.com for the launch strategy. HolonIQ needs connecting to QAS Pulse. Now that HolonIQ is in production, its events still need to reach the Pulse pipeline. Marketing consent is not yet piped through to HubSpot.

Cerebrum

RISKS AND DECISIONS

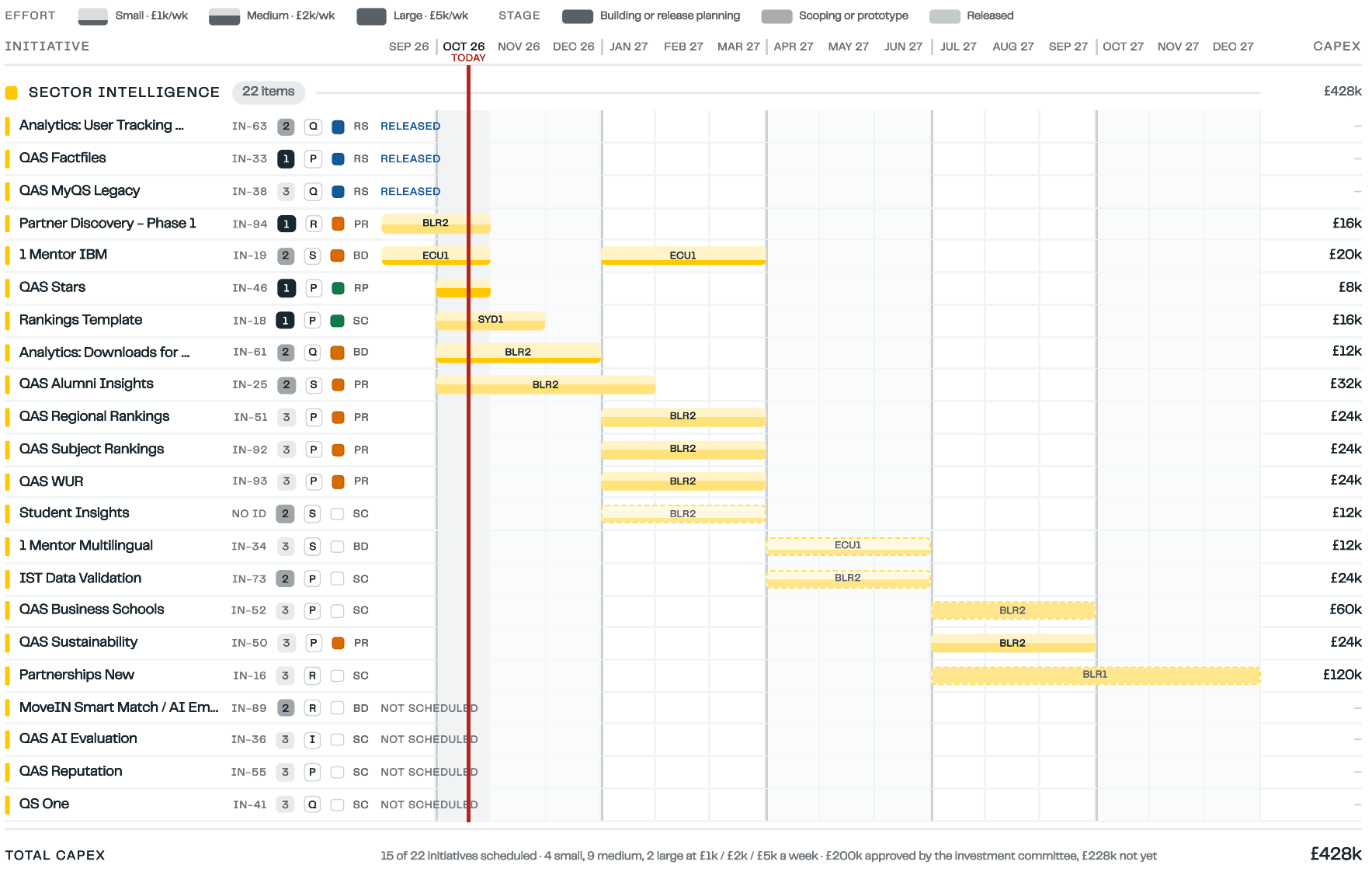
Risks and decisions. A concurrency safeguard is switched off until someone sets it. The protection against two simultaneous submissions colliding on one record lives in a deployment setting, not in code, so no pull request can turn it on. Decision: who sets it, and whether before or after the first real backfill. A fix to the history backfill is still open. A property count was recorded incorrectly during the initial load. Small, but it sits on work described above as shipped. Entity type definitions. Behind schedule.

SECTION 2 OF 4

Sector Intelligence

3 initiatives reported

1 scoping
1 building
1 release planning



TOTAL CAPEX — 15 of 22 initiatives scheduled · 4 small, 9 medium, 2 large at £1k / £2k / £5k a week · £200k approved by the investment committee, £228k not yet — £428k

QAS Stars

IN-46 · BLR2 · RELEASE PLANNING

Launched Rankings Admin in Back Office, completed the QS Stars visual refresh and shipped auth session synchronisation fixes.

1 Mentor IBM

IN-19 · ECU1 · BUILDING

SSO for IBM has been completed and the IBM white-label configuration has been set up. These IBM-requested changes will be deployed to production.

Partnerships New

IN-16 · BLR2 · BLR1 · SCOPING

Launched in-app messaging with chat threads, attachments, transcript export and role-based access controls. QA validation of the role-based modules is complete; chat composer and export testing is in progress. Completed role-based feature segregation for the QPD Dashboard; the solution is in business validation and approaching production deployment.

Risks and decisions. Partner Discovery admin module. It lives in the Back Office, which has moved to legacy, and is still required for some QPD features. Decision needed: migrate it into the Partner Discovery app or create a standalone app. Decision owner to be determined.

BLR2

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Partner Discovery: Launched in-app messaging with chat threads, attachments, transcript export and role-based access controls. QA validation of the role-based modules is complete; chat composer and export testing is in progress. MyQS: Launched Rankings Admin in Back Office, completed the QS Stars visual refresh and shipped auth session synchronisation fixes.

BLR1

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

HUB 2 – Media Partners for Outreach · IPS-2220, IPS-2341: Development is complete and the solution is undergoing testing ahead of planned production deployment. HUB 1: Team onboarding and knowledge transfer are complete; one engineer is actively delivering IPS-2361 and IPS-2362, while another shadows the development lifecycle to build HUB 1 domain knowledge and delivery experience. MyQS QPD: Completed role-based feature segregation for the QPD Dashboard; the solution is in business validation and approaching production deployment.

ECU1

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

IBM integration: SSO for IBM has been completed and the IBM white-label configuration has been set up. These IBM-requested changes will be deployed to production.

ECU2

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Candidate journey analytics (Mixpanel and HubSpot): The team can now see how candidates move through Career Match and where they drop off. Site protection and quality gate: The main site can no longer be updated without passing full automated checks first, reducing the risk of bugs reaching production. Form accessibility improvements: Reduced friction and confusion in form fields for candidates who need extra help. Mobile experience polish for Career Match results: Completed. Parity fixes against the TopUniversities site: Header, footer and link parity fixes are in progress, ongoing.

BLR2

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Partner Discovery admin module. The module currently lives in the Back Office, which has been moved to legacy, and is still required for some QPD features to work. Decision needed: migrate it into the Partner Discovery app or create a standalone app. Decision owner: to be determined.

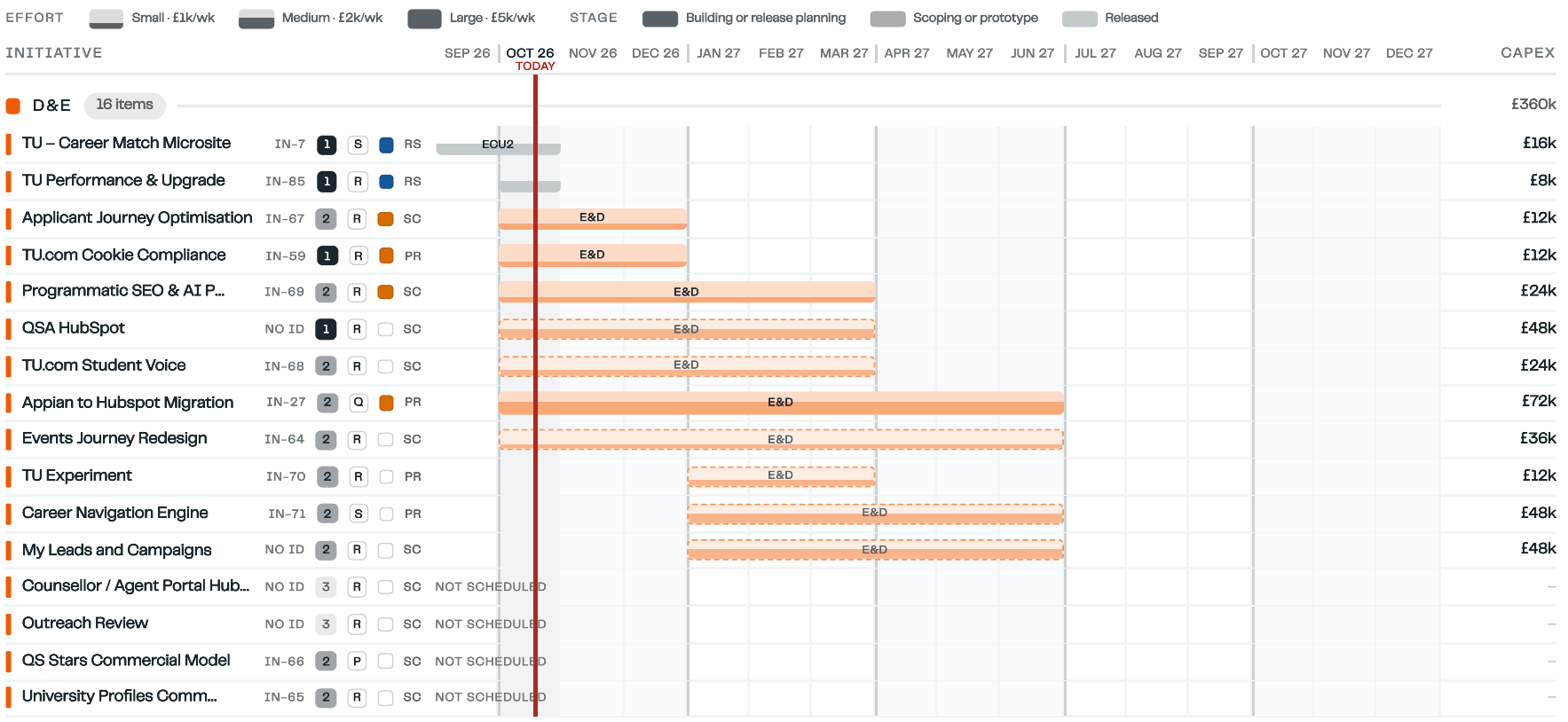
2027 Data and Engineering Delivery Plan

SECTION 3 OF 4

D&E

2 initiatives reported

2 released



TOTAL CAPEX — 12 of 16 initiatives scheduled · 6 small, 6 medium at £1k / £2k / £5k a week · £144k approved by the investment committee, £216k not yet — £360k

TU – Career Match Microsite

IN-7 · ECU2 · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · RELEASED

The team can now see how candidates move through Career Match and where they drop off. The main site can no longer be updated without passing full automated checks first, reducing the risk of bugs reaching production. Reduced friction and confusion in form fields for candidates who need extra help. Completed. Header, footer and link parity fixes are in progress. Released and working as requested.

TU Performance & Upgrade

IN-85 · DIGITAL AND EVENTS · RELEASED

All issues fixed, but the release is on hold until the new servers are set up and tested.

Risks and decisions. Angular upgrade. The decision has been made to wait for the new servers to be set up before releasing this new version.

Digital and Events

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Career Matcher: Released and working as requested. Quick Wins: Updated custom forms released. CMT module conversion from React to Drupal: Testing is still ongoing. QSA page and form: Reported data issues fixed and released. Angular upgrade: All issues fixed, but the release is on hold until the new servers are set up and tested. Agenda builder: Continuing implementation of the last requirements phase, with testing happening in parallel.

QS Apply (Appian)

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Regression fix · applicant status hierarchy: Applicant status is not being updated for some applications associated with the Student and Consent Form Digitalisation flows. The fix is in progress, with release planned for next week after detailed regression testing and validation. Production support requests: Added a Lead Source column to the applicant grid so the enrolment team can identify B2C applicants from the source captured at lead creation; fixed the missing institution names reported by the Finance team on the Finance Dashboard; and added an email address column to the B2B partner dashboard downloadable export.

Digital and Events

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. Angular upgrade. The decision has been made to wait for the new servers to be set up before releasing this new version. Drupal upgrade. Major code development needs to be on hold while all developers upgrade their local environments and all issues are fixed. DevOps team availability will also be needed, so a plan is being aligned with them to make sure the team is fully prepared.

SECTION 4 OF 4

University Services

2 initiatives reported

1 building
1 release planning



Aurora Data Integrity

IN-82 · UBS HUBSPOT SYSTEMS · BUILDING

The process has started to update all missing COI objects across all portals. Added to all portals. Fixed the missing-email issues and updated missing COI objects so that nurture flows could be turned on.

Aurora Implementation

IN-30 · CX SYSTEMS · RELEASE PLANNING

Initiated procurement of a Malaysian (MY) number; set up Aircall–HubSpot Help Desk pipelines; and initiated onboarding of the WhatsApp integration for the landline number.

Risks and decisions. Sunway WhatsApp onboarding. The current number is a landline rather than a mobile number, and Aircall and Twilio do not currently offer Malaysian mobile numbers.

UBS HubSpot Systems

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Data updates for missing COI objects: The process has started to update all missing COI objects across all portals. V2 contact matching workflow: Added to all portals. Activities on tickets: All phone-call tickets have had the calls attached and activities added in all portals. Raw data file imports: Updates made to manage edge-case scenarios. Griffith email and data: Fixed the missing-email issues and updated missing COI objects so that nurture flows could be turned on.

CX Systems

OTHER WORK · NOT LINKED TO AN INITIATIVE

Aircall support: investigated the call-drop issue reported by Derby and raised it with Aircall Support for further debugging; onboarded new users. Sunway University: initiated procurement of a Malaysian (MY) number; set up Aircall–HubSpot Help Desk pipelines; and initiated onboarding of the WhatsApp integration for the landline number. Audit management: completed audit management and asset logs for Aircall, Sakari and Niswey, and attended the internal audit for all three. Aircall IVR: recreated IVRs for universities following the split of teams into two groups. Niswey: conducted testing after removing users to assess potential cost savings. SIP: caught up with Margarita to clarify and resolve SIP-related issues.

UBS HubSpot Systems

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. CIPTEX SIP trunking. Price is in and has been passed to Pratik for negotiation.

CX Systems

RISKS AND DECISIONS

Risks and decisions. IVR changes. The IVR changes require extensive testing to ensure everything is working as expected. Sunway WhatsApp onboarding. There may be limitations with WhatsApp onboarding, as the current number is a landline rather than a mobile number; Aircall and Twilio do not currently offer Malaysian mobile numbers.